

skeptics! the only *honourable* type among the two and five fold ambiguous philosopher crowd!” More trivia: Brochard taught Proust (see Kristeva, 1998).

Brochard seems to have understood Popper’s problem (a few decades before Popper’s birth). He presents the views of the negative empiricism of Menodotus of Nicomedia in similar terms to what we would call today “Popperian” empiricism. I wonder if Popper knew anything about Menodotus. He does not seem to quote him anywhere. Brochard published his doctoral thesis, *De l’erreur*, in 1878 at the University of Paris, on the subject of error—wonderfully modern.

**Epilogism:** We know very little about Menodotus except for attacks on his beliefs by his detractor Galen in the extant Latin version of the *Outline of Empiricism (Subfiguratio empírica)*, hard to translate:

*Memoriam et sensum et vocans epilogismum hoc tertium, multotiens autem et preter memoriam nihil aliud ponens quam epilogismum.* (In addition to perception and recollection, the third method is *epilogism sensum*, as the practitioner has, besides memory, nothing other than *epilogism* senses; Perilli’s correction.

But there is hope. Perilli (2004) reports that, according to a letter by the translator Is-haq Bin Hunain, there may be a “transcription” of Menodotus’s work in Arabic somewhere for a scholar to find.

**Pascal:** Pascal too had an idea of the confirmation problem and the asymmetry of inference. In his preface to the *Traité du vide*, Pascal writes (and I translate):

In the judgment they made that nature did not tolerate a vacuum, they only meant nature in the state in which they knew it, since, so claim so in general, it would not be sufficient to witness it in a hundred different encounters, nor in a thousand, not in any other number no matter how large, since it would be a single case that would deny the general definition, and if one was contrary, a single one ...

**Hume’s biographer:** Mossner (1970). For a history of skepticism, Victor Cousin’s lectures *Leçons d’histoire de la philosophie à la Sorbonne* (1828) and Hippolyte Taine’s *Les philosophes classiques*, 9th edition (1868, 1905). Popkin (2003) is a modern account. Also see Heckman (2003) and Bevan (1913). I have seen nothing in the modern philosophy of probability linking it to skeptical inquiry.

**Sextus:** See Popkin (2003), Sextus, House (1980), Bayle, Huet, Annas and Barnes (1985), and Julia Anna and Barnes’s introduction in Sextus Empiricus (2000). Favier (1906) is hard to find; the only copy I located, thanks to Gur Huberman’s efforts, was rotten—it seems that it has not been consulted in the past hundred years.

**Menodotus of Nicomedia and the marriage between empiricism and skepticism:** According to Brochard (1887), Menodotus is responsible for the mixing of empiricism and Pyrrhonism. See also Favier (1906). See